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(54) **METHODS FOR PACKAGING CANNABIS**

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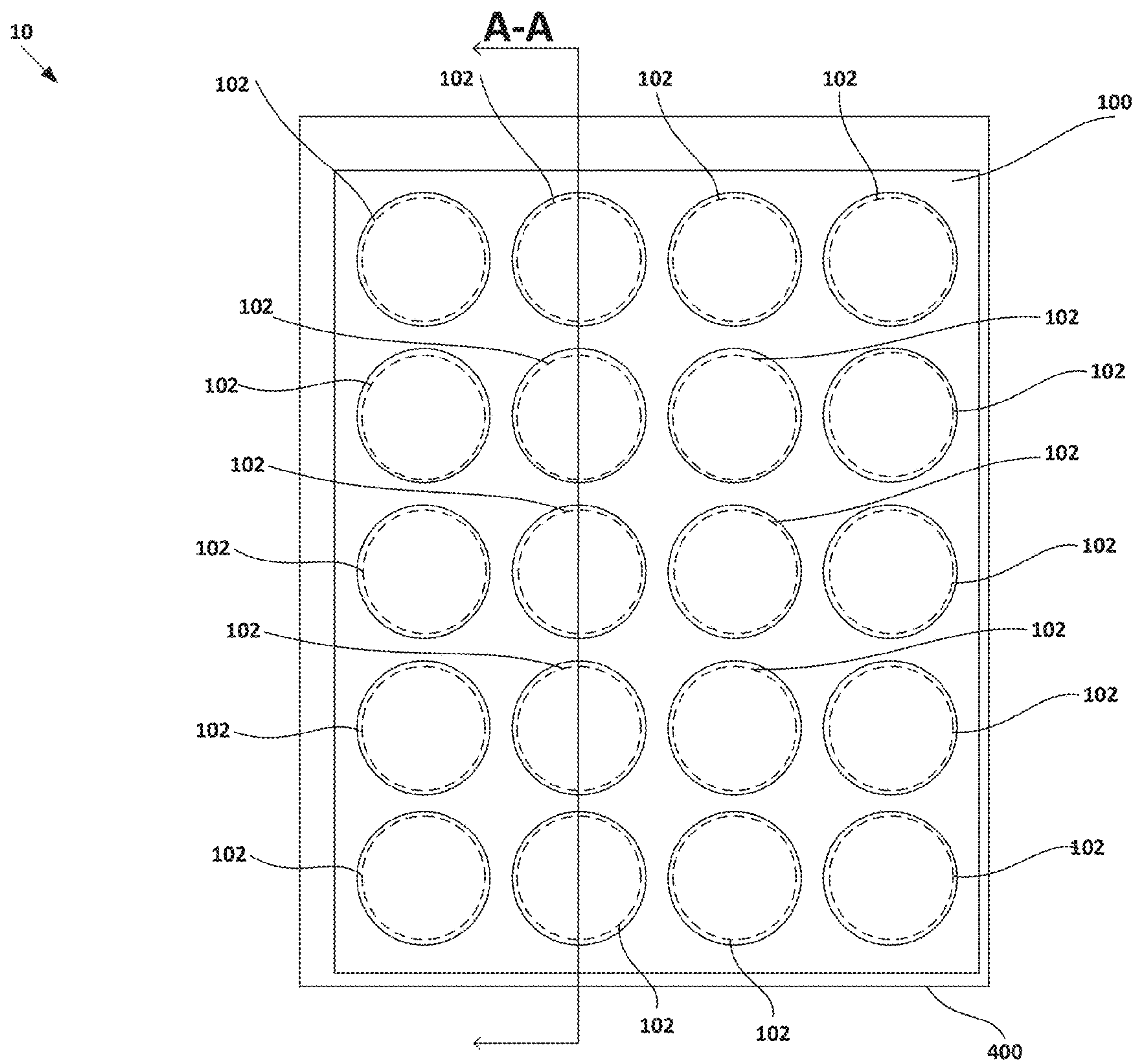
(57) **ABSTRACT**

A method for packaging *cannabis* includes placing a first portion of ground *cannabis* into a first capsule mold of a tray. The method also includes pressing the first portion of ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold to form a first *cannabis* puck. The method also includes attaching a first cover to the tray to cover the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold. The method also includes attaching a first pull tab to the first cover. The first pull tab is configured to be grasped by a user when the user removes the first cover from covering the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold.



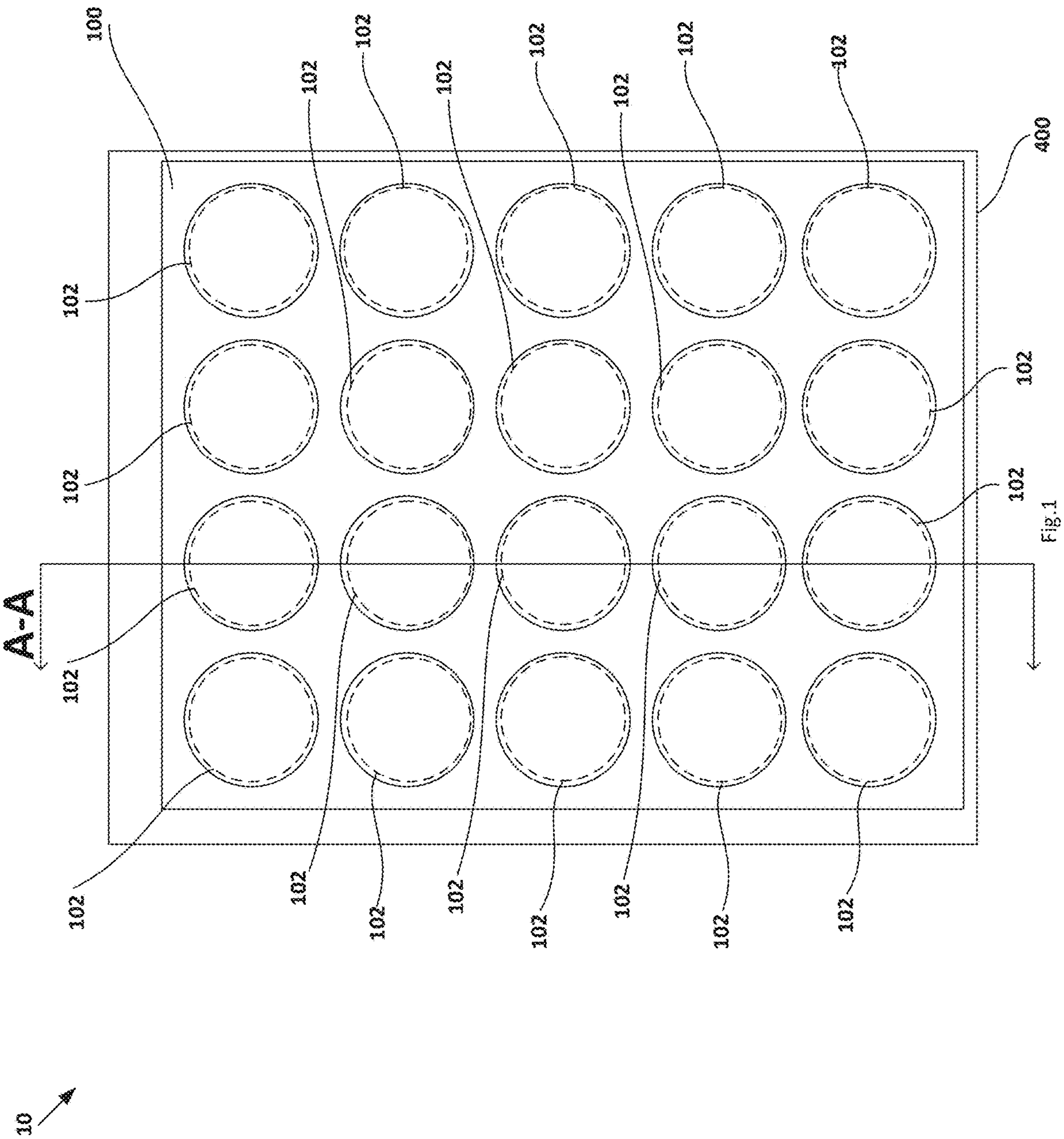


Fig.1

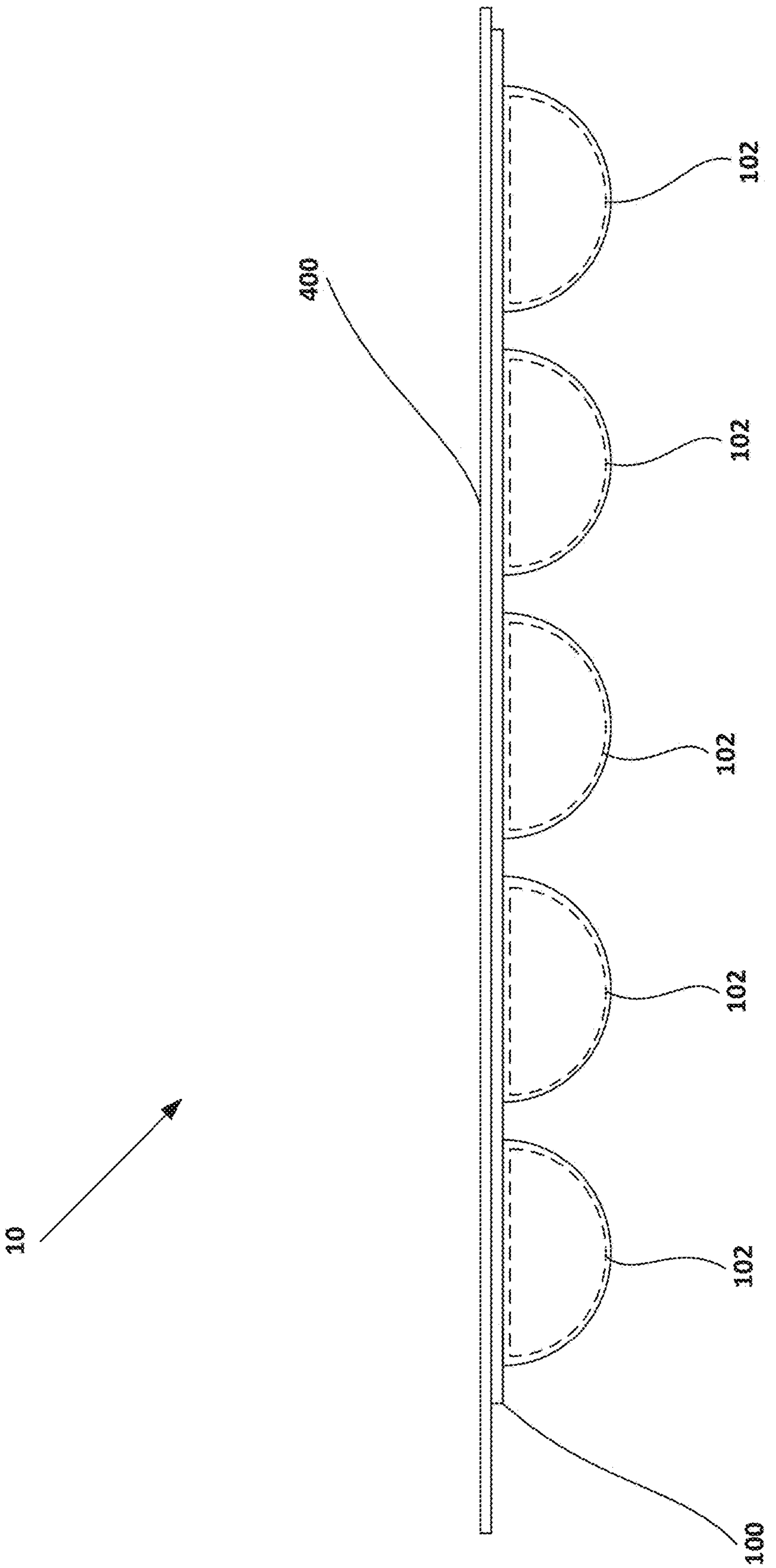


Fig.2

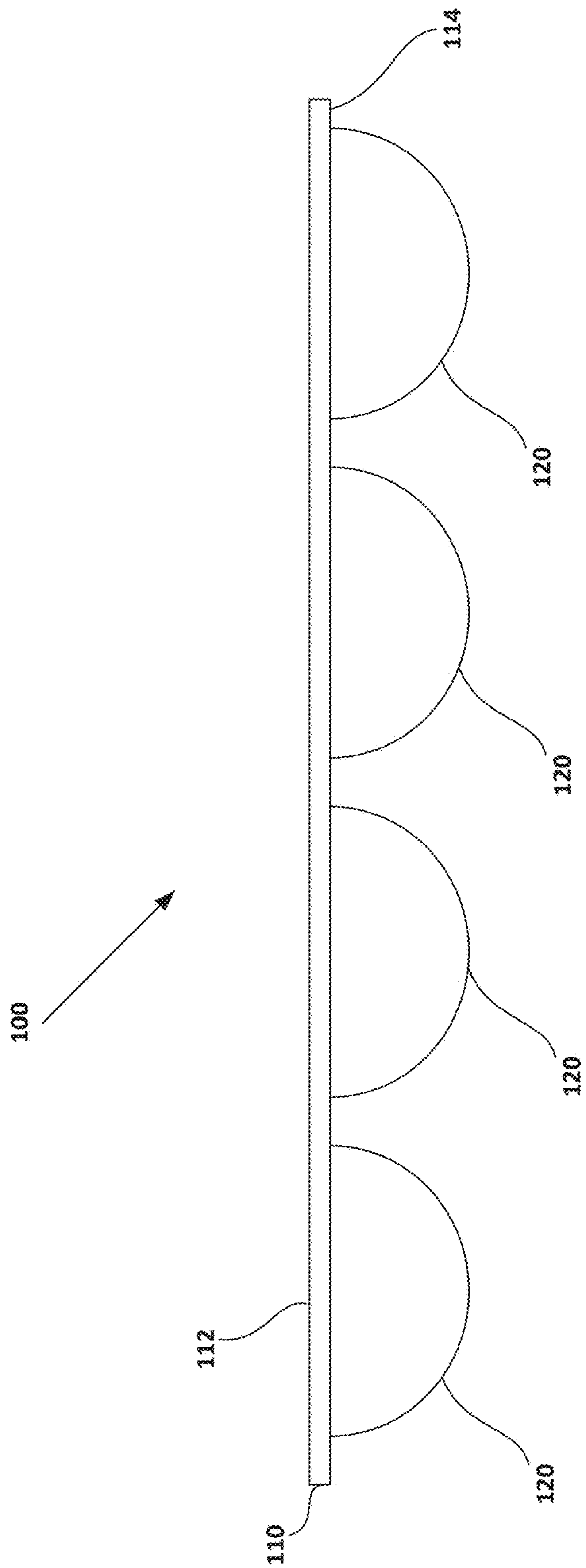


Fig.3

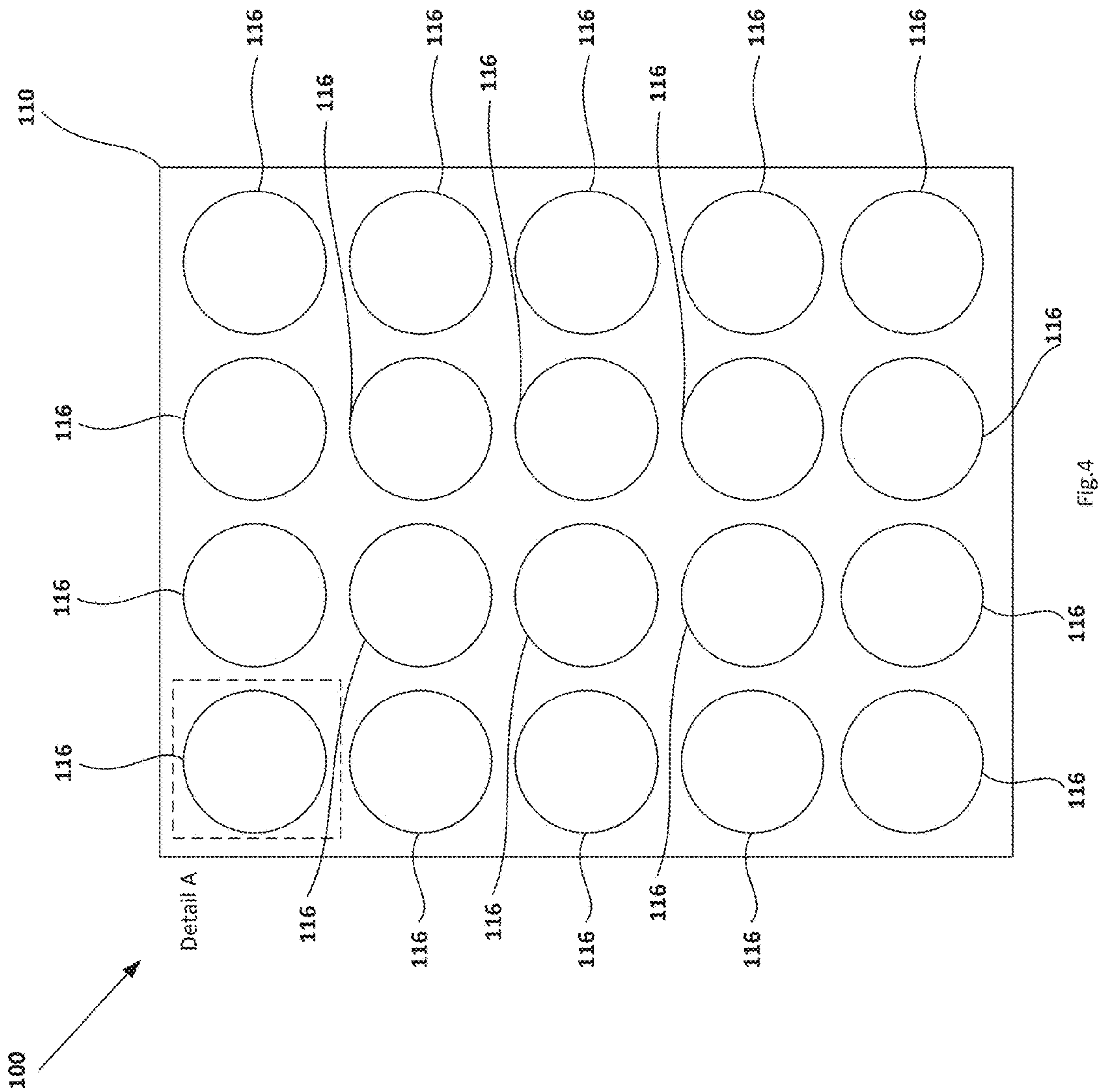


Fig.4

Section A-A

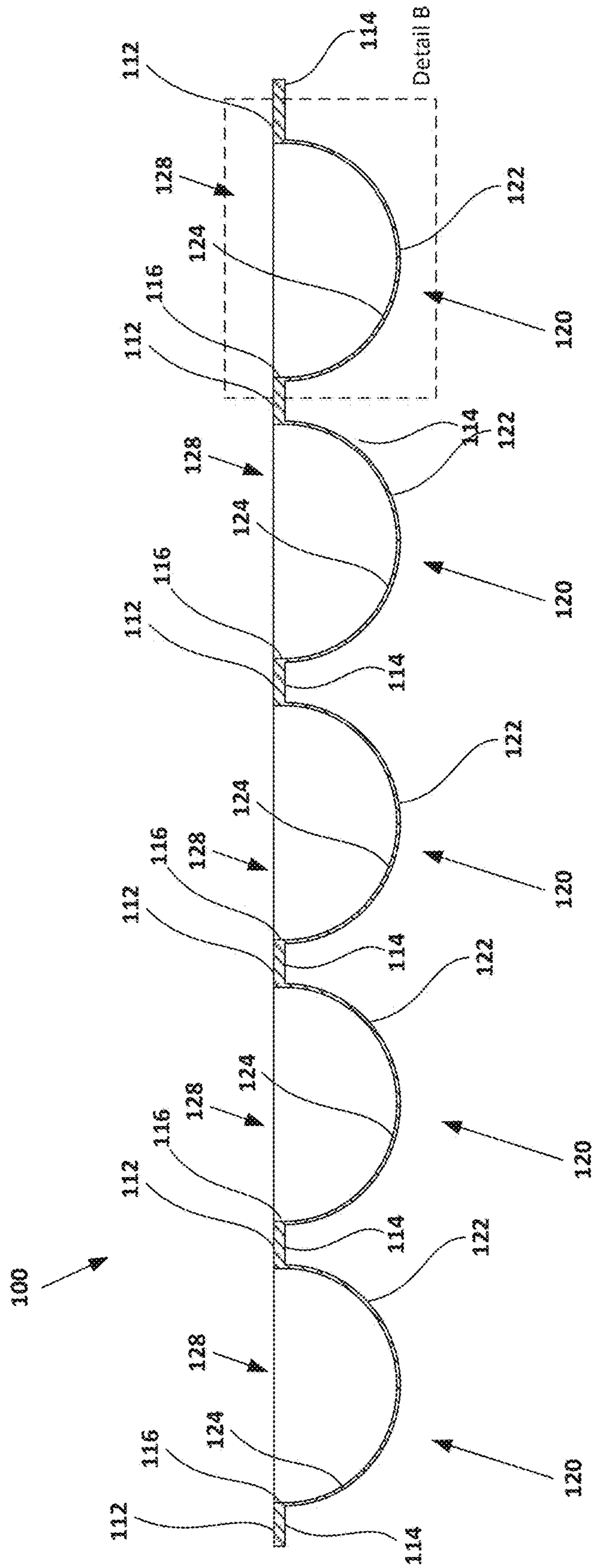


Fig.5

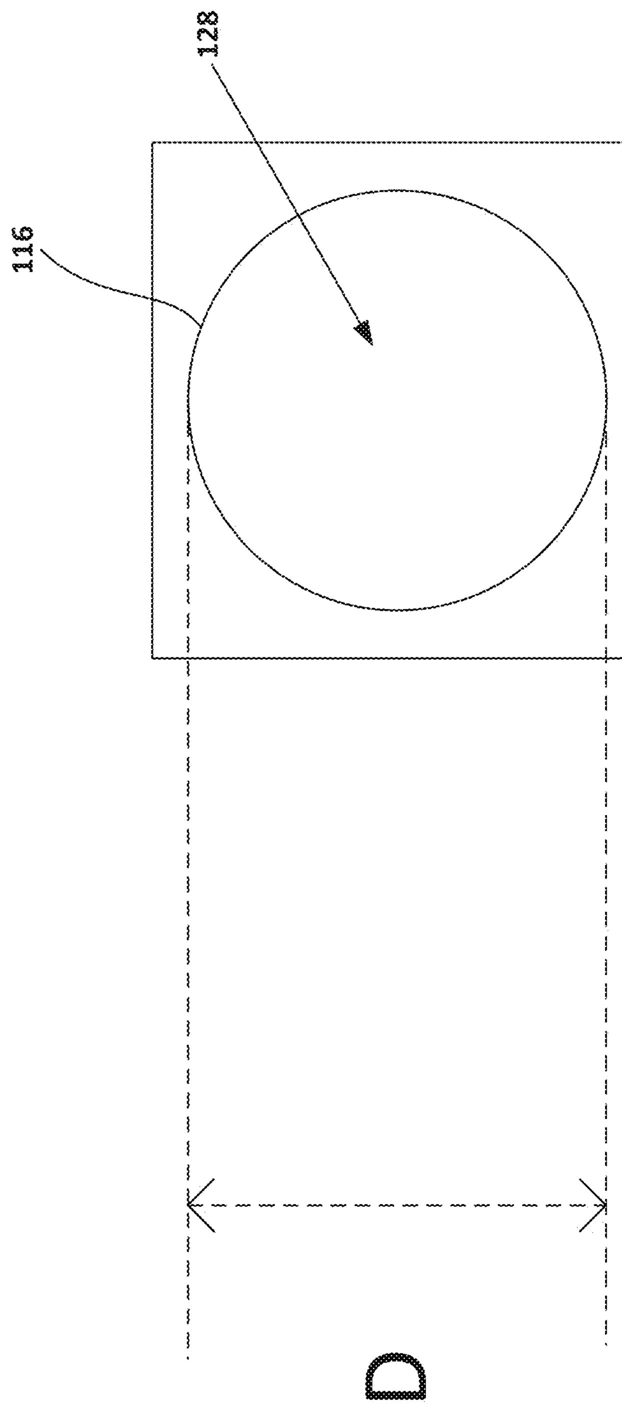


Fig.6

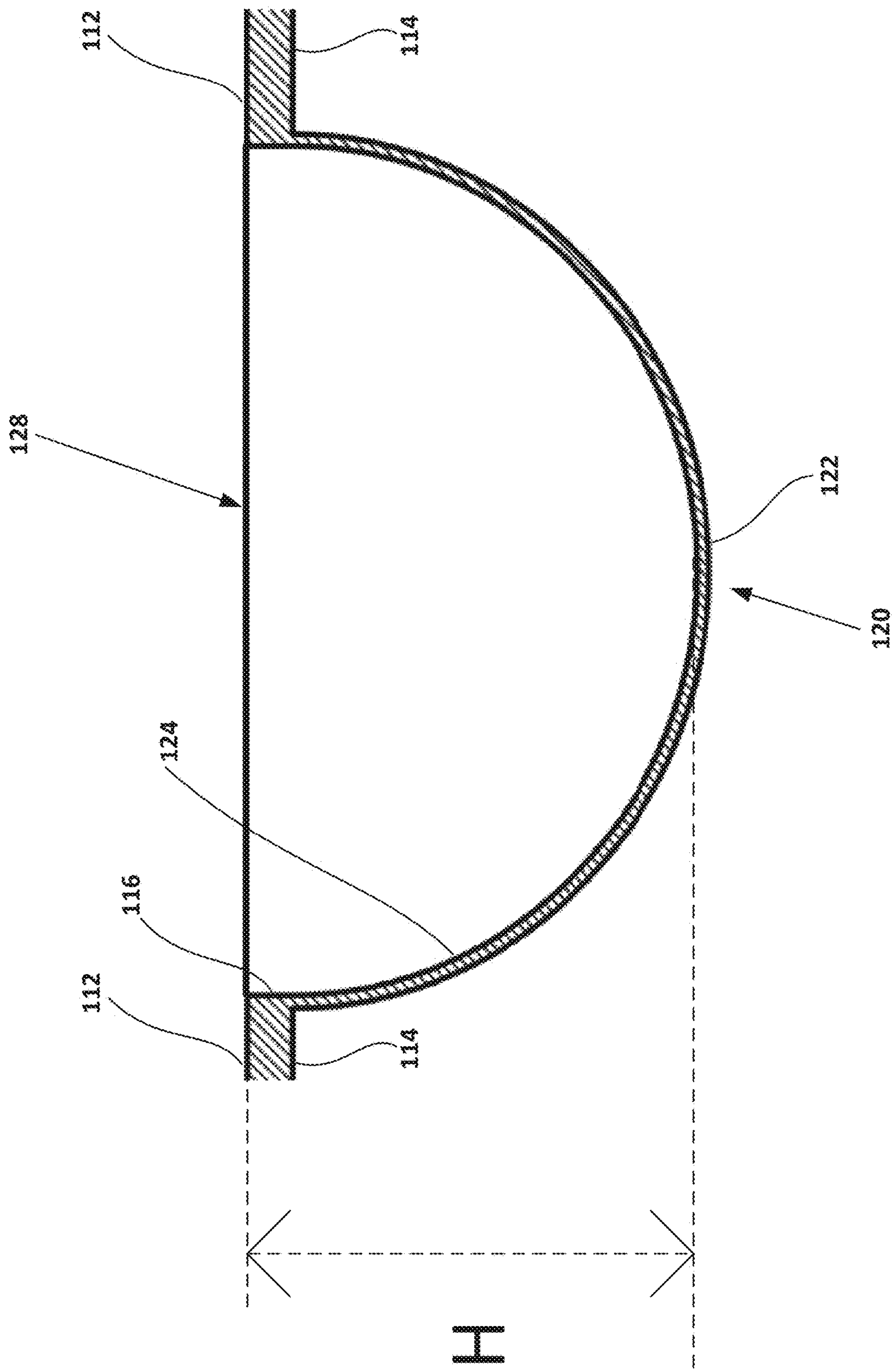


Fig.7

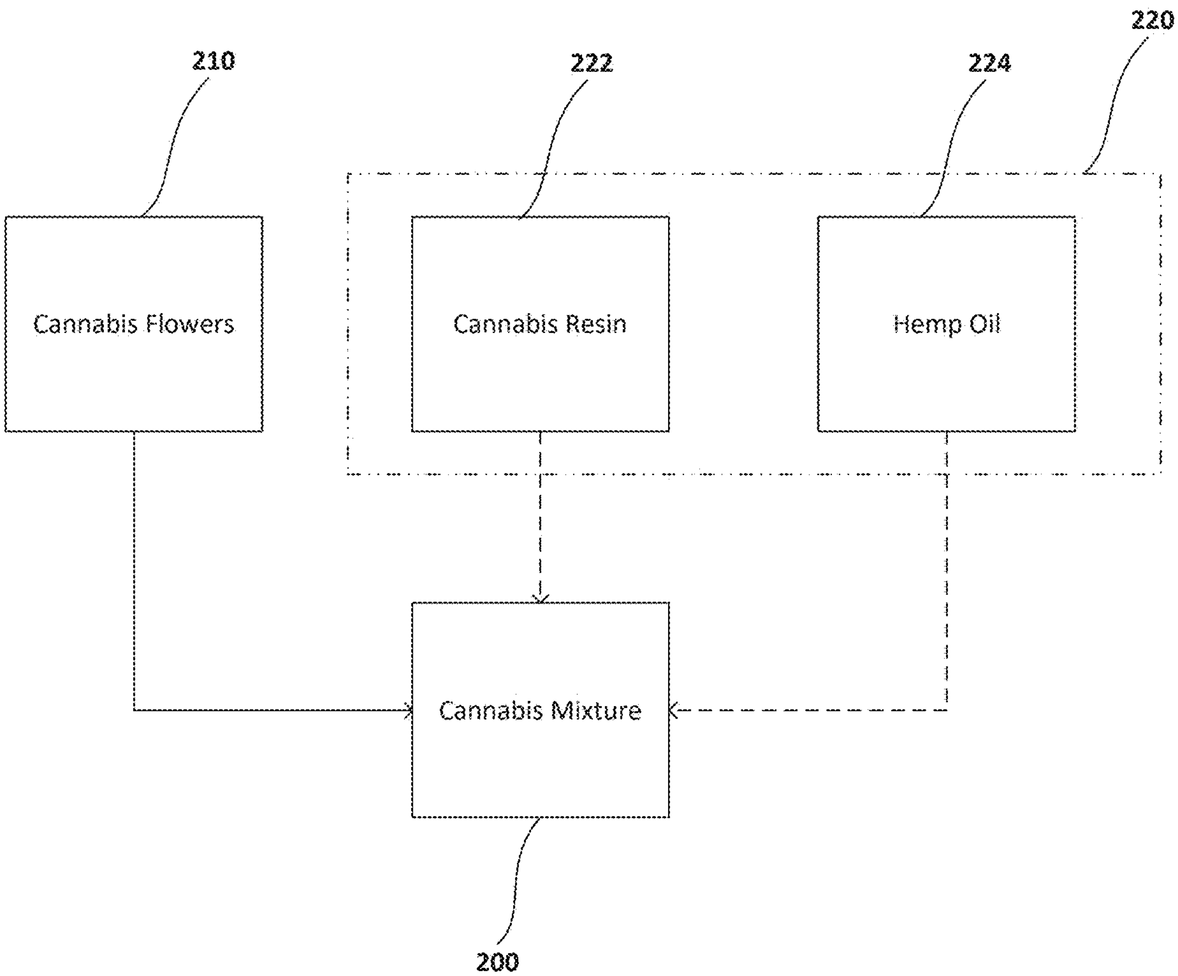

210
222
224
220
Cannabis Flowers
Cannabis Resin
Hemp Oil
Cannabis Mixture
200

Fig.8

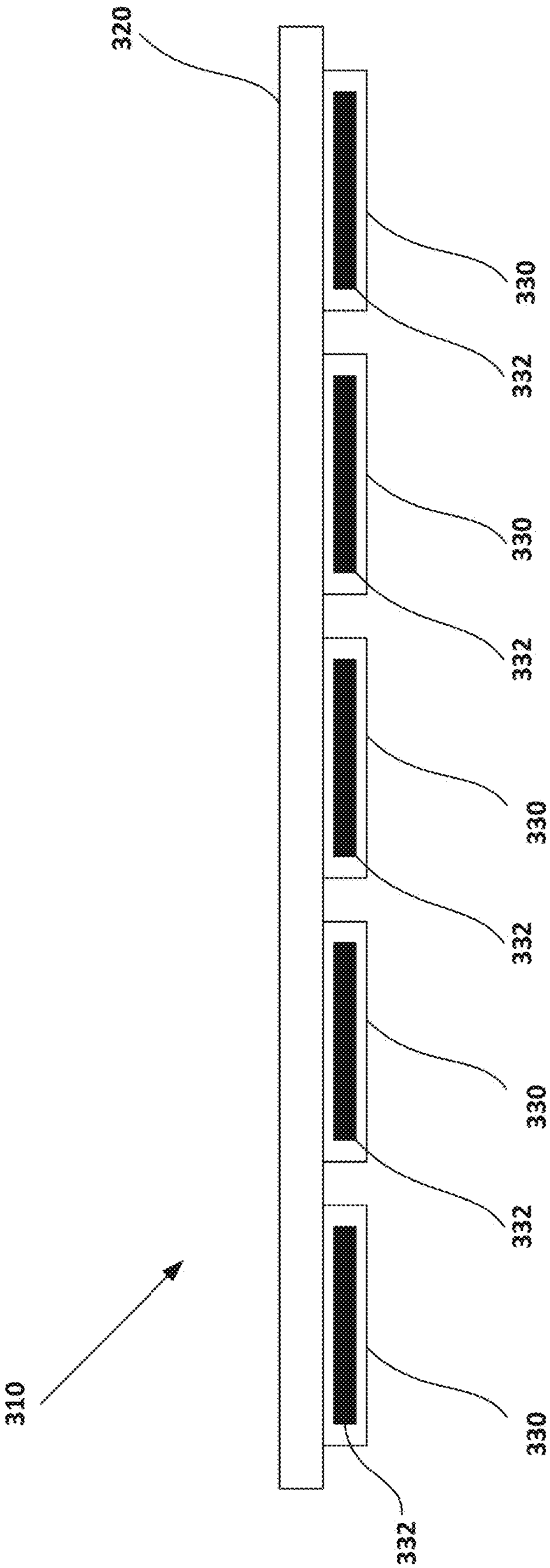


Fig.9

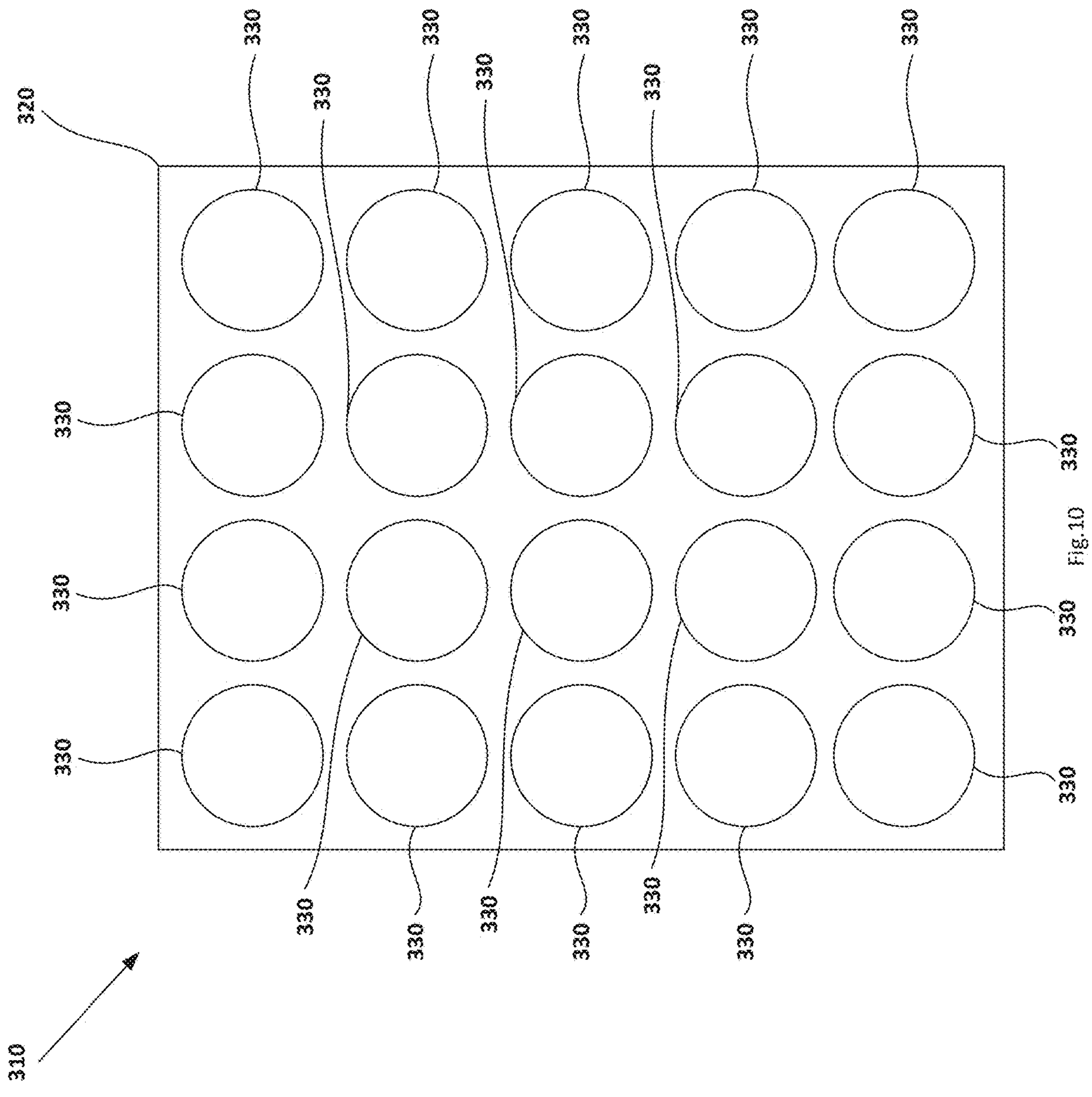


Fig.10

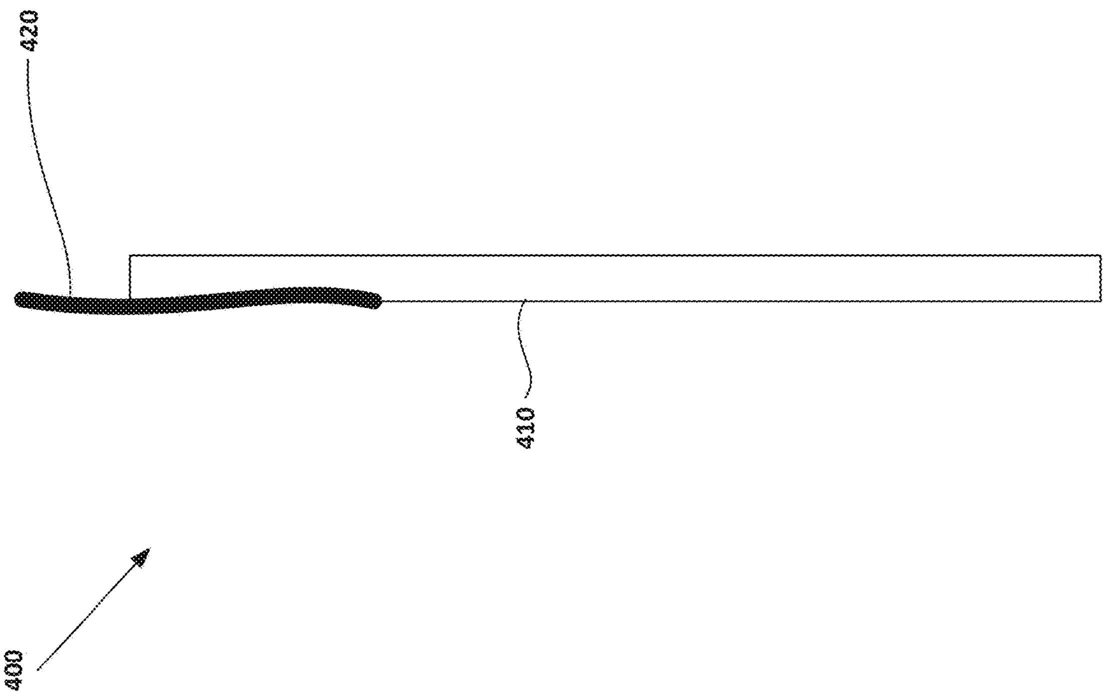


Fig.11

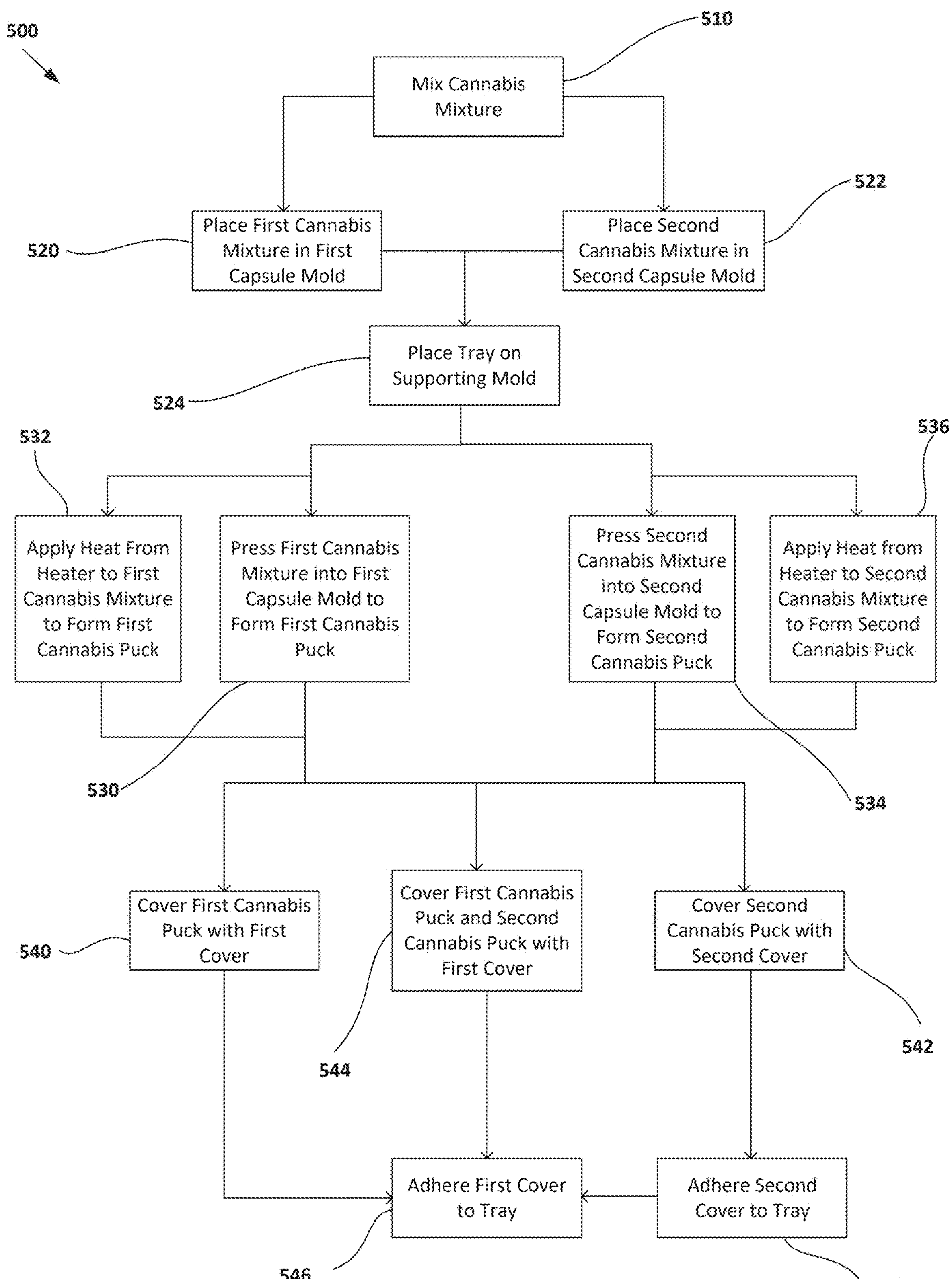

500
510
Mix Cannabis Mixture
520
Place First Cannabis Mixture in First Capsule Mold
522
Place Second Cannabis Mixture in Second Capsule Mold
524
Place Tray on Supporting Mold
532
Apply Heat From Heater to First Cannabis Mixture to Form First Cannabis Puck
Press First Cannabis Mixture into First Capsule Mold to Form First Cannabis Puck
Press Second Cannabis Mixture into Second Capsule Mold to Form Second Cannabis Puck
536
Apply Heat from Heater to Second Cannabis Mixture to Form Second Cannabis Puck
530
534
540
Cover First Cannabis Puck with First Cover
Cover First Cannabis Puck and Second Cannabis Puck with First Cover
Cover Second Cannabis Puck with Second Cover
544
542
Adhere First Cover to Tray
Adhere Second Cover to Tray
546
548

Fig.12

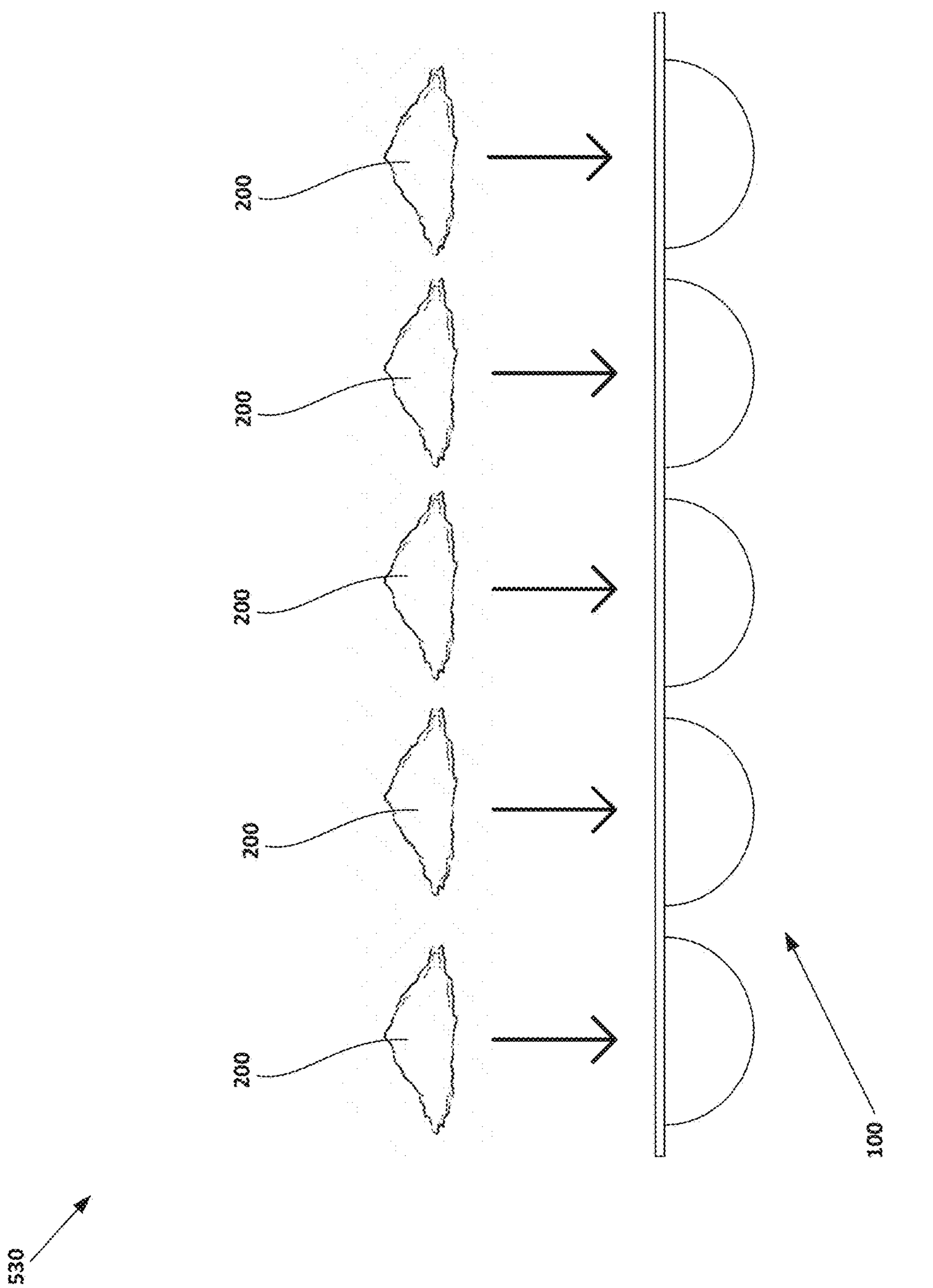


Fig.13

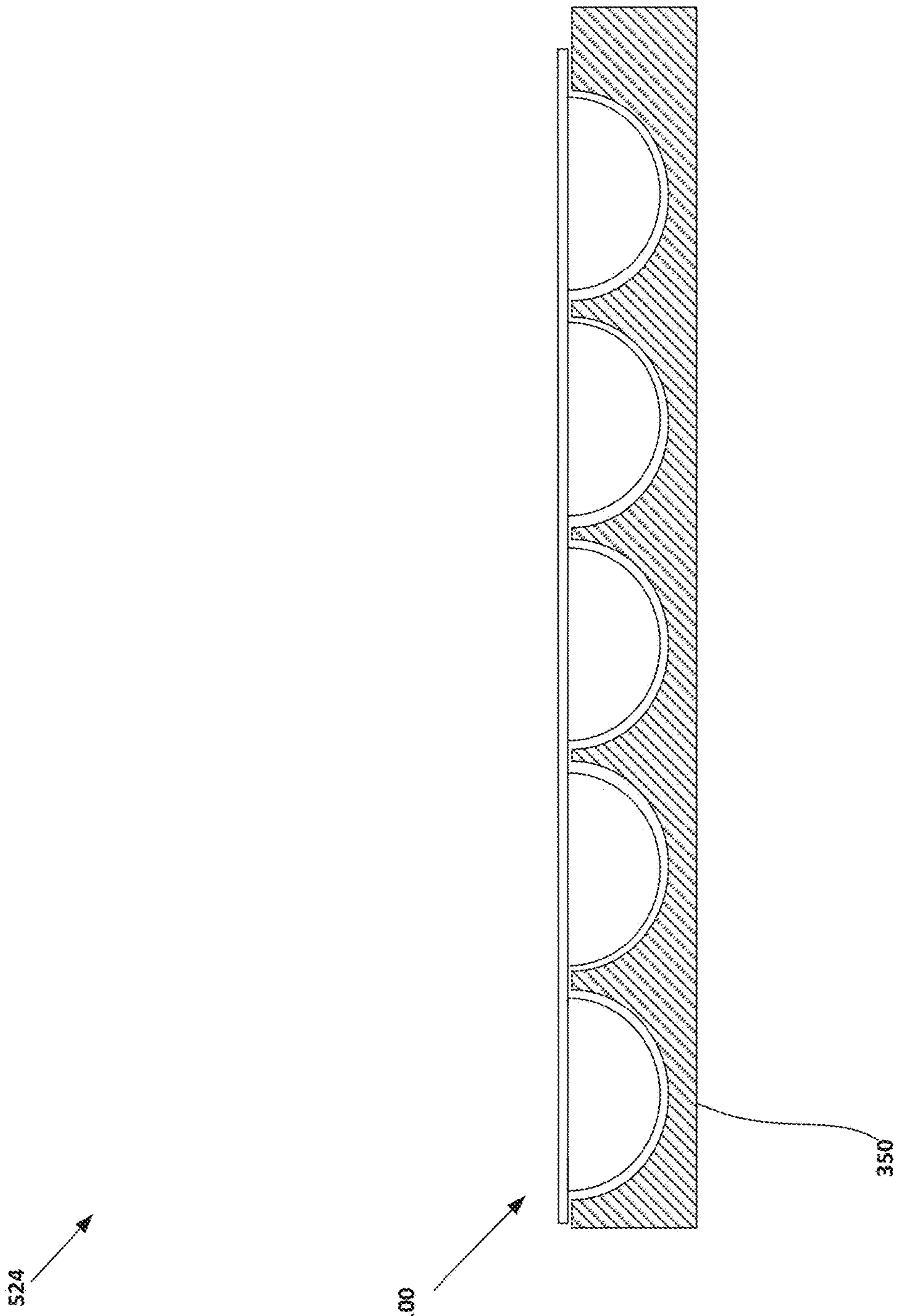


Fig.14

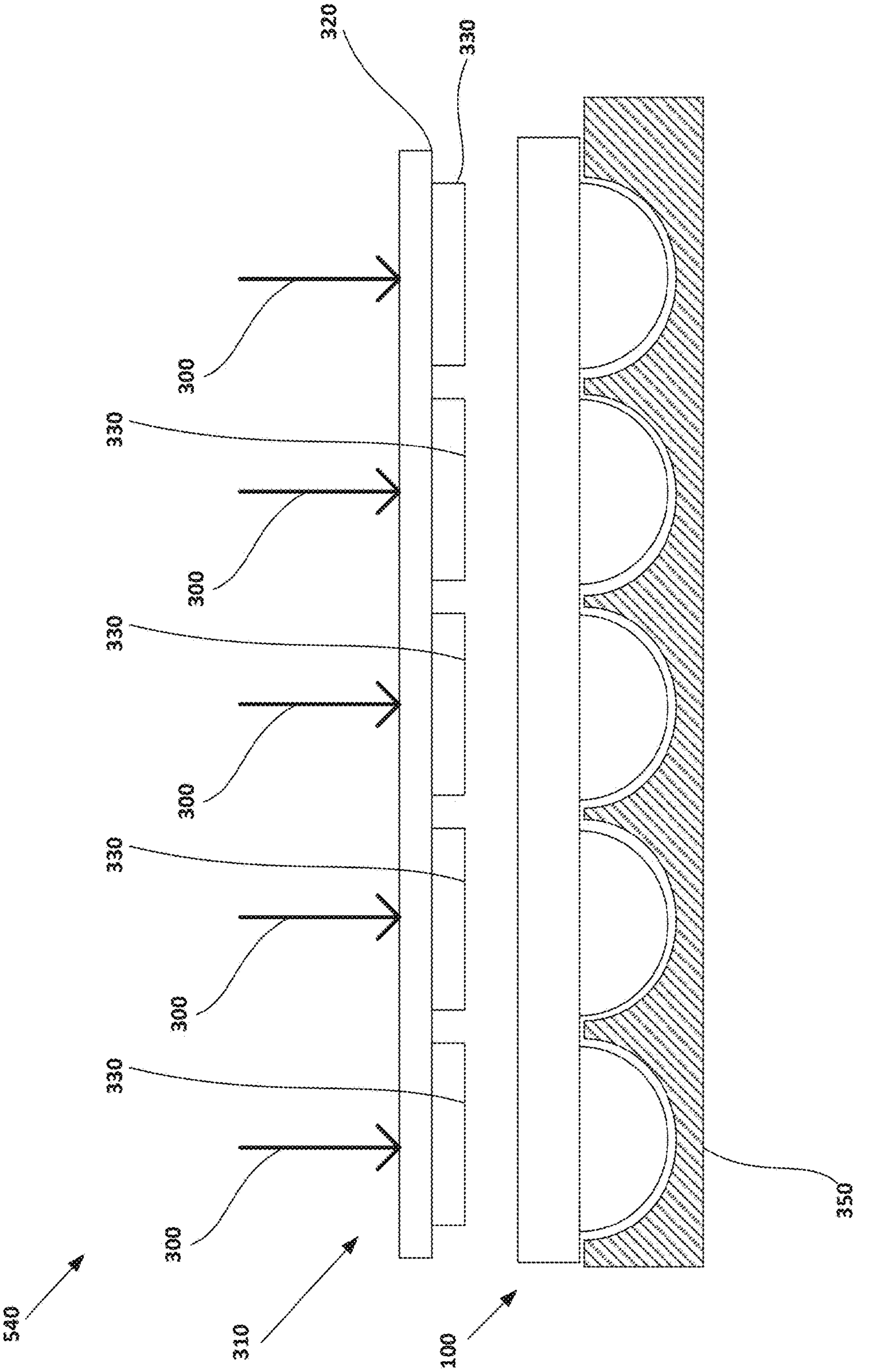


Fig.15

Section A-A

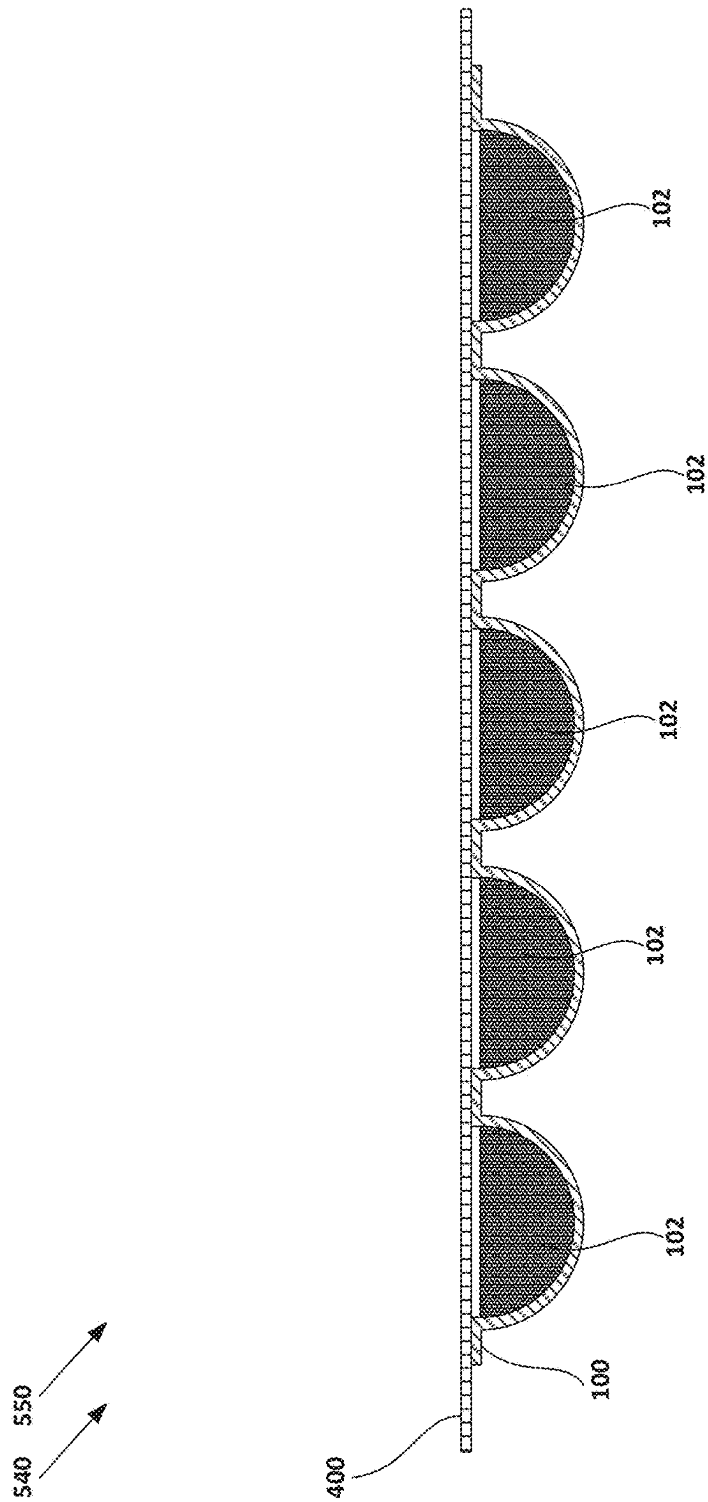


Fig.16

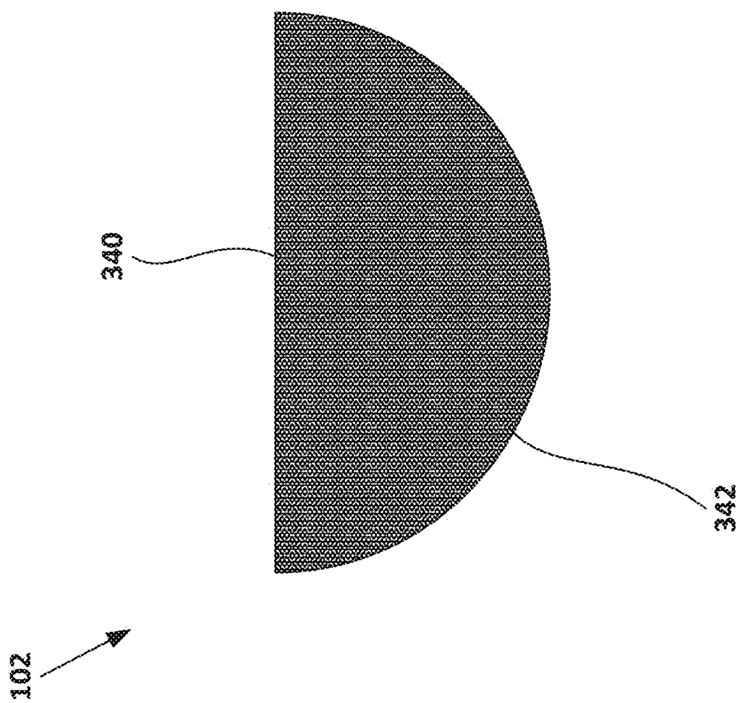


Fig. 17

METHODS FOR PACKAGING CANNABIS

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/336,729, filed Jun. 16, 2023, the entire contents of which are incorporated by reference herein.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Portions of *cannabis* may be sealed in a package for sale. Further, the *cannabis* may be part of a *cannabis* mixture that incorporates other elements such as a binder. The *cannabis* or the *cannabis* mixture may then be removed from the package and placed into a pipe or other smoking device for consumption. However, a package containing a relatively large portion of the *cannabis*, such as *cannabis* buds or unground *cannabis*, or *cannabis* mixture may make portioning for consumption difficult. For example, a user may desire to divide, such as separating *cannabis* buds from stems and grinding the *cannabis* buds, the relatively large portion into smaller portions. This may require the user to estimate that the smaller portions are of a suitable size for consumption, which can be tedious and lead to waste.

SUMMARY

[0003] One embodiment is directed towards a method for packaging *cannabis*. The method includes placing a first *cannabis* mixture into a first capsule mold of a tray. The method also includes pressing the first *cannabis* mixture into a first inside surface of the first capsule mold to form a first *cannabis* puck. The first inside surface is rounded in two directions. The method also includes attaching a first cover to the tray to cover the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold.

[0004] Another embodiment is directed toward a method for packaging *cannabis*. The method includes mixing a *cannabis* mixture. The *cannabis* mixture includes a portion of ground *cannabis* and a binder. The binder is configured to bond together the portion of ground *cannabis*. The method also includes placing the *cannabis* mixture into a capsule mold of a tray. The method also includes pressing the *cannabis* mixture into the capsule mold of the tray to form a *cannabis* puck. The method also includes adhering a film cover to the tray to cover the *cannabis* puck in the capsule mold.

[0005] Yet another embodiment is directed toward a method for packaging *cannabis*. The method includes placing a first *cannabis* mixture into a first capsule mold of a tray. The method also includes placing a second *cannabis* mixture into a second capsule mold of the tray. The method also includes pressing the first *cannabis* mixture into the first capsule mold to form a first *cannabis* puck while pressing the second *cannabis* mixture into the second capsule mold to form a second *cannabis* puck simultaneously.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0006] FIG. **1** is a top view of an example *cannabis* pack;
[0007] FIG. **2** is a side view of the *cannabis* pack of FIG. **1**;
[0008] FIG. **3** is a side view of a tray of the *cannabis* pack of FIG. **1**;
[0009] FIG. **4** is a top view of the tray of FIG. **1**;
[0010] FIG. **5** is a cross-section view of the tray of FIG. **1** taken along plane A-A;
[0011] FIG. **6** is a view of Detail A of FIG. **4**;
[0012] FIG. **7** is a view of Detail B of FIG. **5**;
[0013] FIG. **8** is a block diagram of a *cannabis* mixture;
[0014] FIG. **9** is a side view of an example press;
[0015] FIG. **10** is a bottom view of the press of FIG. **9**;
[0016] FIG. **11** is a side view of a film cover of the *cannabis* pack of FIG. **1**;
[0017] FIG. **12** is a block diagram of an example method for packaging *cannabis;*
[0018] FIG. **13** is a side view of an example of a step of placing a *cannabis* mixture into a capsule mold of a tray of the method for packaging *cannabis* shown in FIG. **12**;
[0019] FIG. **14** is a side view of an example of a step of placing the tray on a supporting mold of the method for packaging *cannabis* shown in FIG. **12**;
[0020] FIG. **15** is a side view of an example of a step of pressing the *cannabis* mixture into the capsule mold to form a *cannabis* puck of the method for packaging *cannabis* shown in FIG. **12**;
[0021] FIG. **16** is a cross-section view of an example of a step of attaching a first cover to the tray to cover the *cannabis* puck in the capsule mold of the method for packaging *cannabis* shown in FIG. **12** taken along plane A-A; and
[0022] FIG. **17** is a side view of an example of a step of removing the *cannabis* puck from the capsule mold after the conclusion of the method for packaging *cannabis* shown in FIG. **12**.

[0023] It will be recognized that some or all of the Figures are schematic representations for purposes of illustration. The Figures are provided for the purpose of illustrating one or more implementations with the explicit understanding that they will not be used to limit the scope or the meaning of the claims.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0024] Following below are more detailed descriptions of various concepts related to, and implementations of, methods, apparatuses, and for packaging *cannabis*. The various concepts introduced above and discussed in greater detail below may be implemented in any of a number of ways, as the described concepts are not limited to any particular manner of implementation. Examples of specific implementations and applications are provided primarily for illustrative purposes.

I. Overview

[0025] Some methods of packaging include placing a *cannabis* mixture (e.g., *cannabis* flowers, *cannabis* buds, *cannabis* trichomes, etc.) in a package (e.g., a bag, a container, etc.). For example, the *cannabis* mixture may be placed in a bag and sold in stores. After being purchased, a user typically portions (e.g., divides, allocates, etc.) the *cannabis* mixture further into a dose (e.g., a portion, a serving, etc.), grinds the *cannabis* mixture, and then places the ground *cannabis* mixture in a bowl (e.g., a receptable, etc.) of a smoking device (e.g., a pipe, a bubbler, etc.) before igniting the ground *cannabis* mixture (e.g., to smoke, to inhale, etc.).

[0026] A user may portion the *cannabis* mixture into the dose by eye (e.g., by estimating, etc.) or using a scale (e.g., by weighing out an amount, etc.). For example, the user may portion the *cannabis* mixture based on previous experiences. The user may also place the portion of the *cannabis* mixture on a scale in order to obtain a predetermined amount of *cannabis* mixture. However, because these systems require previous knowledge of an ideal portion of the *cannabis* mixture, they are undesirable for beginners who may not know these ideal portions. It may be difficult for a beginner user to portion an intended amount of the *cannabis* mixture because they do not have the required previous knowledge of an ideal portion. As a result, the beginner user may incorrectly portion the *cannabis* mixture into the dose and experience undesirable results (e.g., not getting high, getting too high, etc.). Additionally, different types of *cannabis* mixtures may have different concentrations of active ingredients (e.g., Tetrahydrocannabinol (THC), Cannabidiol (CBD), etc.). As a result, a user having experience with a different *cannabis* mixture may incorrectly portion the *cannabis* mixture into the dose and also experience undesirable results.

[0027] Additionally, *cannabis* products that require a user to portion the *cannabis* mixture may be difficult for users with disabilities (e.g., multiple sclerosis, muscular dystrophy, Alzheimer's, etc.). For example, a user with cerebral palsy may have reduced motor function. It may be difficult for the user with cerebral palsy to portion the *cannabis* mixture, grind the *cannabis* mixture, and place the ground *cannabis* mixture into a bowl because of impaired motor function, for example.

[0028] Rather than requiring a user to portion the *cannabis* mixture, some methods of packaging *cannabis* include portioning the *cannabis* mixture into a dose and compressing the *cannabis* mixture into a *cannabis* puck. However, these *cannabis* pucks may not be correctly sized to fit into a bowl (e.g., compressed to fit inside a vaporizer, etc.). As a result, the *cannabis* puck may not be able to be used in a method preferred by a user (e.g., smoke *cannabis* from a pipe, etc.).

[0029] Additionally, these *cannabis* pucks may be manufactured using multiple molds. For example, the *cannabis* pucks may be compressed in a first mold and then transferred to a container (e.g., package, capsule, etc.). As a result, this method of packaging *cannabis* may require a manufacturer to handle the *cannabis* pucks multiple times, which increases the manufacturing cost. As another result, the manufacturer must retain additional equipment and floor space for the multiple molds in order to create the compressed puck.

[0030] Implementations described herein are related to a method of packaging *cannabis* that does not require a user to portion the *cannabis* mixture. Instead, the *cannabis* mixture is packaged into an optimal dose in the form of a *cannabis* puck. As a result, the user may utilize the *cannabis* puck without having any previous knowledge of an ideal portion of the *cannabis* mixture and may expect a consistent dosage of active ingredients. Additionally, the method of packaging *cannabis* described herein includes compressing the *cannabis* mixture into the *cannabis* puck inside of a capsule mold and then sealing the *cannabis* puck into the capsule mold. As a result, a manufacturer is able to efficiently form and subsequently package the *cannabis* puck without handling the *cannabis* puck to move it from a mold to a separate package. Thus, the manufacturer is able to quickly seal the *cannabis* puck inside of the capsule mold and reduce manufacturing costs associated with use of separate mold and packaging.

II. Overview of *Cannabis* Package

[0031] FIG. **1** depicts an example *cannabis* pack **10** (e.g., a *cannabis* box, a *cannabis* package, a *cannabis* container, etc.). As is described in more detail herein, the *cannabis* pack **10** is configured to store one or more *cannabis* pucks **102** for purchase. The *cannabis* puck **102** is shown in FIG. **1** and FIG. **2** in dashed (e.g., phantom, etc.) lines. In some embodiments, the *cannabis* pack **10** is configured to store a plurality of the *cannabis* pucks **102** (e.g., a first *cannabis* puck **102**, a second *cannabis* puck **102**, etc.) for purchase. Each of the *cannabis* pucks **102** may be removed and consumed by a user. Importantly, as described in more detail herein, the *cannabis* pack **10** facilitates formation of the *cannabis* pucks **102** (e.g., from a *cannabis* mixture) in addition to storage of the *cannabis* pucks **102**.

[0032] The *cannabis* pack **10** includes a tray **100** (e.g., platter, container, etc.). The tray **100** is configured to support the *cannabis* puck **102** during formation and storage. The tray **100** includes a tray plate **110** (e.g., board, plate, etc.). As described in more detail herein tray plate **110** is configured to support a mold that facilitates the formation of the *cannabis* puck **102** and couple to a cover that covers the *cannabis* puck **102** after it has been formed. The tray plate **110** defines a tray top **112** (e.g., a top surface, etc.) and a tray bottom **114** (e.g., a bottom surface, etc.). The tray **100** also defines a tray aperture **116** (e.g., a hole, an opening, etc.). The tray aperture **116** is configured to allow material to pass through the tray plate **110**. In some embodiments, the tray **100** defines a plurality of tray apertures **116** (e.g., a first tray aperture **116**, a second tray aperture **116**, etc.). The tray aperture **116** defines an aperture diameter D. In some embodiments, the aperture diameter D is between 18 millimeters to 22 millimeters. In other embodiments, the aperture diameter D is less than 18 millimeters. In still other embodiments, the aperture diameter D is greater than 22 millimeters. In some embodiments, the tray aperture **116** is generally round (e.g., circular, ovular, etc.). In other embodiments, the tray aperture **116** may take on a different shape (e.g., a square, a rectangle, etc.).

[0033] The tray **100** also includes a capsule mold **120** (e.g., a compartment cast, a mold, etc.). The capsule mold **120** is coupled to the tray bottom **114**. In some embodiments, the tray plate **110**, the tray aperture **116**, and the capsule mold **120** of the tray **100** are integrally formed (e.g., injection molded, form a single body, etc.). In over embodiments, one or more components of the tray **100** are otherwise coupled together (e.g., fastened, adhesively coupled, etc.). The capsule mold **120** is configured to receive and store the *cannabis* puck **102**. The capsule mold **120** is also configured as a mold (e.g., a die, a cast, etc.) that allows for the *cannabis* puck **102** to be pressed (e.g., compressed, compacted, etc.) into the capsule mold **120**. The capsule mold **120** is made of a rigid material (e.g., rigid plastic, steel, aluminum, etc.) that resists deformation (e.g., changes in shape, etc.) when a predetermined compressive force (e.g., force required to form the *cannabis* puck **102**, etc.) is applied to the *cannabis* puck **102** inside of the capsule mold **120**. In some embodiments, the capsule mold **120** is made a rigid material (e.g., rigid plastic, steel, aluminum, etc.) that it does not deform when the predetermined compressive force is applied to the *cannabis* puck **102** inside of the capsule mold **120**.

[0034] The capsule mold **120** is contiguous with (e.g., shares a border with, etc.) the tray aperture **116**. In some embodiments, the tray **100** includes a plurality of capsule molds **120** (e.g., a first capsule mold, a second capsule mold, etc.) and each of capsule molds **120** are coupled to the tray bottom **114** and are contiguous with one of tray apertures **116**.

[0035] The capsule mold **120** defines a capsule exterior **122** (e.g., outside surface, etc.). The capsule exterior **122** is configured to support (e.g., hold, rest on, etc.) the tray **100** when it is placed on a surface (e.g., a table, a shelf, etc.). In some embodiments, the capsule exterior **122** is rounded in two directions (e.g., a semi-sphere, a bulge, etc.) In other embodiments, the capsule exterior **122** has a different shape (e.g., a cube shape, an oval shape, etc.). In some embodiments, the capsule exterior **122** is configured to support the tray **100** when the *cannabis* puck **102** is pressed into the capsule mold **120**.

[0036] The capsule mold **120** also defines a capsule interior **124** (e.g., an inside surface, etc.). The capsule interior **124** is configured to support (e.g., hold, contain, etc.) the *cannabis* puck **102**. The capsule interior **124** is rounded in two perpendicular or near perpendicular directions (e.g., semi-sphere, bulge, etc.). The capsule interior **124** defines a first radius of curvature in a first direction and a second radius of curvature in a second direction perpendicular or near perpendicular to the first direction. In some embodiments, the first radius of curvature and the second radius of curvature are equal such that the capsule interior **124** forms a semi-sphere. In other embodiment, the firs radius of curvature is greater than the second radius of curvature. In still other embodiments, the second radius of curvature is greater than the first radius of curvature. The capsule interior **124** may be entirely rounded such that a rounded portion of the capsule interior **124** extend from the shared border with the tray aperture **116**. In other embodiments, the rounded portion of the capsule interior **124** may not extend from the shared border with the tray aperture **116** (e.g., the capsule interior **124** may extend straight down from the tray aperture **116** before rounding, etc.). The capsule interior **124** may be rounded in two perpendicular directions match an inside surface (e.g., an inside profile, etc.) of a bowl (e.g., receptacle, chamber for holding an ignited substance, etc.) of a device for smoking a substance (e.g., a bong, a smoking pipe, etc.) such that an object shaped with a confronting relation to the capsule interior **124** can be placed into the bowl of the device for smoking a substance. In other embodiments, the capsule interior **124** has a different shape (e.g., a cube shape, an oval shape, etc.). In some embodiments, the capsule molds **120** each define a capsule interior **124** (e.g., a first inside surface, a second inside surface, etc.). The capsule interior **124** may be embossed (e.g., raised, extruded, etc.) or debossed (e.g., sunken, etc.) with a signifier (e.g., icon, mark, logo, etc.). The signifier may be a brand name (e.g., logo, etc.) or an identifier of the *cannabis* puck **102** (e.g., THC concentration, *cannabis* strain, etc.) In operation, the embossed or debossed signifier may be imprinted (e.g., etched, transferred, etc.) from the capsule interior **124** to the *cannabis* puck **102** when the *cannabis* puck **102** is pressed into the capsule interior **124** such that the *cannabis* puck **102** is marked with (e.g., displays, presents, etc.) the signifier. The capsule interior **124** may also be covered with a coating (e.g., a spray, an enamel, etc.) configured to reduce the adherence between the capsule interior **124** and the *cannabis* puck **102**.

[0037] The capsule interior **124** and the tray top **112** define a capsule height H (e.g., a depth of the capsule, etc.) from the tray top **112** to the bottom of the capsule interior **124**. In some embodiments, the capsule height H is between 8 millimeters and 12 millimeters, inclusive. In other embodiments, the capsule height H is less than 8 millimeters. In still other embodiments, the capsule height H is greater than 12 millimeters.

[0038] The capsule interior **124** and the tray top **112** also define a capsule void **128** (e.g., an empty space, a compartment, etc.). The capsule void **128** is configured to store (e.g., fit, contain, etc.) the *cannabis* puck **102**. In some embodiments, each of the capsule interiors and the tray top **112** also define a plurality of capsule voids **128**. Each of the capsule voids **128** is configured to store one of the *cannabis* pucks **102**.

[0039] The *cannabis* puck **102** starts as a *cannabis* mixture **200** (e.g., a *cannabis* blend, a *cannabis* compound, etc.). The *cannabis* mixture **200** includes a portion of ground *cannabis* **210**. The portion of ground *cannabis* **210** is made up of ground *cannabis* flower that has been ground down to a specific ground size. The portion of ground *cannabis* **210** contains an amount of THC and other active ingredients (e.g., CBD, etc.). In some embodiments, an additive may be added to the *cannabis* mixture **200** to reduce the adherence between the *cannabis* mixture **200** and the capsule interior **124**.

[0040] In some embodiments, the *cannabis* mixture **200** also includes a binder **220** (e.g., a *cannabis* concentrate, a thickener, a glue, etc.). The binder **220** is configured to bind together (e.g., connect, etc.) the portion of the ground *cannabis* **210** when a compressive force **300** (e.g., a compacting force, a pressing force, etc.) is applied to the *cannabis* mixture **200**. The binder **220** includes at least one of a portion of *cannabis* resin **222** or a portion of hemp oil **224** (e.g., full spectrum CBD oil, broad spectrum CBD oil, etc.). The portion of *cannabis* resin **222** is a sticky substance that may be produced from *cannabis* trichomes by applying heat and pressure to the *cannabis* trichomes. The sticky nature of the portion of *cannabis* resin **222** allows it to bind together the portion of ground *cannabis* **210** when a compressive force **300** is applied to the *cannabis* mixture **200**. The portion of hemp oil **224** is an oil that may be produced by cold pressing hemp seeds from a hemp plant. The portion of hemp oil **224** may be mixed with the portion of ground *cannabis* **210** to create a paste which becomes a solid when a compressive force **300** is applied to the *cannabis* mixture **200**. In some embodiments, the binder **220** includes both the portion of *cannabis* resin **222** and the portion of hemp oil **224**. In other embodiments, the *cannabis* mixture **200** does not include the binder **220** and the ground *cannabis* **210** is configured to bind itself together when a compressive force **300** is applied to the *cannabis* mixture **200** or by a combination of the compressive force **300** and heat applied to the *cannabis* mixture **200**.

[0041] The *cannabis* mixture **200** is placed into the capsule mold **120** through the tray aperture **116**. The *cannabis* mixture **200** weighs between 0.30 grams and 0.40 grams. In other embodiments, the *cannabis* mixture **200** weighs less than 0.30 grams. In still other embodiments, the *cannabis* mixture **200** weighs more than 0.40 grams. The *cannabis* mixture **200** also contains between 8 milligrams and 12 milligrams of THC. In other embodiments, the *cannabis* mixture **200** contains less than 8 milligrams of THC. In still other embodiments, the *cannabis* mixture **200** contains greater than 12 milligrams of THC. In some embodiments, a plurality of *cannabis* mixtures **200** (e.g., a first *cannabis* mixture **200**, a second *cannabis* mixture **200**, etc.) are each placed into one of the capsule molds **120**.

[0042] In some embodiments, the compressive force **300** may be applied to the *cannabis* mixture **200** using a press **310** (e.g., a compactor, a puck maker, etc.). In other embodiments, the compressive force **300** may be applied to the *cannabis* mixture **200** by hand (e.g., manually applying the compressive force **300**, etc.). The press **310** includes a press plate **320**. The press plate **320** is configured to receive a force or a pressure and transfer the force or the pressure to a component described herein.

[0043] The press **310** also includes a press cylinder **330** (e.g., a tamper, a compressor rod, etc.). The press cylinder **330** is coupled to a bottom face of the press plate **320**. The press cylinder **330** is configured to drift (e.g., pass through, etc.) the tray aperture **116** of the tray **100**. In some embodiments, the press **310** includes a plurality of press cylinders **330** coupled to the bottom face of the press plate **320** and each are configured to drift one of tray apertures **116** of the tray **100**. A bottom face of the press cylinder **330** may contain an embossed or debossed signifier. The signifier may be a brand name or an identifier of the *cannabis* mixture **200** (e.g., THC concentration, *cannabis* strain, etc.). In some embodiments, the bottom face of the press cylinder **330** is textured (e.g., with bumps, with ridges, etc.). A textured bottom face of the press cylinder **330** creates a textured surface on the *cannabis* mixture **200** which may ease the ignition of the *cannabis* mixture **200** (e.g., allow for more surface area to be ignited, allow for oxygen to reach more of a surface of, etc.) after compression. The bottom face of the press cylinder **330** may also be covered with a coating (e.g., a spray, an enamel, etc.) configured to reduce the adherence between the bottom face of the press cylinder **330** and the *cannabis* mixture **200**.

[0044] The press **310** also includes a heater **332** (e.g., a resistance heater, an electrical heater, a thermoelectric heater, a piezoelectric heater, etc.). In various embodiments, the heater **332** is coupled to the press cylinder **330**. For example, the press cylinder **330** may include a recess and the heater **332** may be inserted into the recess and coupled to the press cylinder **330** (e.g., using adhesive, etc.). The heater **332** may be configured to increase a temperature of the press cylinder **330** such that the temperature of the press cylinder **330**. For example, the heater **332** may be configured to increase the temperature of the press cylinder **330** such that the temperature of the press cylinder **330** is higher than a surrounding ambient temperature. In some embodiments, the heater **332** is an electric heater (e.g., a heater that produces heat when supplied by electricity, etc.). In other embodiments, the heater **332** may be configured to heat the press cylinder **330** to a specific temperature (e.g., a temperature required to compress the *cannabis* mixture **200** into the *cannabis* puck **102**, etc.). In other embodiments, the heater **332** is coupled to the press plate **320** so that the heater **332** increases the temperature of the press plate **320**, which in turn increases the temperature of the press cylinder **330**. In some embodiments, the press **310** includes a plurality of heaters **332** each coupled to one of the plurality of press cylinders **330**. While not shown, a system includes a controller and a power source, in addition to the heater **332**, the press cylinder **330**, the press **310**, and the press plate **320**. The controller is configured to cause power from the power source to be provided to the heater **332** (e.g., to increase the temperature, etc.).

[0045] In operation, after the *cannabis* mixture **200** has been placed inside the capsule mold **120** of the tray **100**, force is applied to the press plate **320**. The press plate **320** transfers this force to the press cylinder **330**. The press cylinder **330** applies the compressive force **300** on the *cannabis* mixture **200** which causes the binder **220** to bind together the portion of the ground *cannabis* **210** to form a *cannabis* puck **102**. The press cylinder **330** may also apply heat from the heater **332** (e.g., the controller may cause power from the power source to be provided to the heater) to the *cannabis* mixture **200** which also causes the binder **220** to bind together the portion of the ground *cannabis* **210** to form a *cannabis* puck **102**. In other embodiments the press cylinder **330** applies the compressive force **300** and heat from the heater **332** to the *cannabis* mixture **200** which causes the *cannabis* mixture **200** to bind itself together. The *cannabis* puck **102** is configured to be a solid or semi-solid composition with enough structural integrity to maintain its shape and form under environmental conditions and to have a relatively large surface to volume ratio. In some embodiments, the compressive force **300** may be transferred form the press plate **320** to the press cylinders **330**. Each of the press cylinders **330** apply a portion of the compressive force **300** on one of the *cannabis* mixtures **200**, which simultaneously form a plurality of *cannabis* pucks **102** (e.g., a first *cannabis* puck **102**, a second *cannabis* puck **102**, etc.).

[0046] The *cannabis* puck **102** defines a puck top **340** (e.g., a top surface, etc.). The puck top **340** is configured to match a profile of a bottom face of the press cylinder **330** after it has applied the compressive force **300** to the *cannabis* mixture **200**. The puck top **340** may be embossed or debossed with the textures and signifiers present on the bottom face of the press cylinder **330**. In other embodiments, the puck top **340** may also be embossed separately from receiving the compressive force **300** from the press cylinder **330** (e.g., after the press **310** has been removed, etc.). The puck top **340** may also be ignited when a user places the *cannabis* puck **102** into a pipe to smoke the *cannabis* puck **102**. In some embodiments, the textures embossed or debossed on the puck top **340** may ease the ignition of the puck top **340** (e.g., allow for more surface area to be ignited, allow for oxygen to reach more of the puck top **340**, etc.).

[0047] The *cannabis* puck **102** also defines a puck bottom **342** (e.g., a bottom surface, etc.). The puck bottom **342** is configured to match the capsule interior **124**. The puck bottom **342** is formed when the compressive force **300** forces the *cannabis* mixture **200** against the capsule interior **124**. The puck bottom **342** may be embossed or debossed with the textures and signifiers present on the capsule interior **124** of the capsule mold **120**. In some embodiments, the puck bottom **342** is configured to accommodate a device such as a pipe or a bong. In these embodiments, the puck bottom **342** is configured with a confronting relation with a bowl of the device. The *cannabis* puck **102** can then be placed into the bowl of the device. The *cannabis* puck **102** is also configured to allow for smoke from the combustion of the puck top **340** to travel through *cannabis* puck **102** and emerge from the puck bottom **342**.

[0048] In operation, a user may place the *cannabis* puck **102** into the device so that the puck bottom **342** contacts the bowl of the device. The user may then ignite a portion of the *cannabis* puck **102**, such as the puck top **340**, thereby causing combustion of a portion of the *cannabis* puck **102** and the production of smoke. The user may then inhale through a mouthpiece such that the smoke is drawn from the puck top **340** through the *cannabis* puck **102**, through the puck bottom **342**, and then through the device into the mouth of the user.

[0049] The *cannabis* pack **10** also includes a cover **400** (e.g., a film cover, a lid, etc.). The cover **400** is configured to be placed on the tray top **112** of the tray **100** and cover (e.g., obscure, seal, etc.) the tray aperture **116**. In some embodiments, the cover **400** is configured to cover the tray apertures **116**. In other embodiments, a plurality of covers **400** (e.g., a first cover **400**, a second cover **400**, etc.) are each configured to cover one of the tray apertures **116**. The cover **400** is impermeable to air (e.g., to prevent contamination, etc.) and is opaque (e.g., to prevent degradation of the *cannabis* puck **102** by light, etc.). In other embodiments, the cover **400** is partially or fully clear (e.g., so a user may see the *cannabis* puck **102** through the film cover, etc.). In operation, after the compressive force **300** has formed the *cannabis* puck **102**, the cover **400** is placed on the tray top **112** to cover the *cannabis* puck **102** located inside of the capsule mold **120**.

[0050] In some embodiments the cover **400** includes an adhesive **410** (e.g., a glue, a binder, etc.). The adhesive **410** is bonded to a face of the cover **400**. The adhesive **410** is configured to adhere to the tray top **112** of the tray **100** when the cover **400** is placed on the tray **100** to cover the capsule mold **120**. In some embodiments, the adhesive **410** is configured to repeatedly releasably adhere to the tray **100**. In this way, the cover **400** may be removed to expose the *cannabis* pucks **102** so that a user may remove one of the *cannabis* pucks **102** for consumption before re-adhering the cover **400** to the tray top **112** using the adhesive **410** to cover the *cannabis* pucks **102** remaining in the tray **100**, thereby preventing the degradation of the *cannabis* pucks **102** remaining in the tray **100** by exposure to oxygen and/or light.

[0051] The cover **400** also includes a pull tab **420** (e.g., a handle, a string, etc.). The pull tab **420** is coupled to the cover **400** such that the pull tab **420** extends beyond the outside of the cover **400**. In some embodiments, the pull tab **420** is adhered to the bottom surface of the cover **400** with the adhesive **410**. In other embodiments, the pull tab **420** is coupled to the cover **400** using alternate means (e.g., thermal welding, integrated during manufacture, etc.). The pull tab **420** is configured to extend from the cover **400** when the cover **400** is adhered to the tray **100** such that it may be grasped (e.g., grabbed, handled, etc.) and pulled (e.g., yanked, lifted, etc.) to assist with removing the cover **400** from the tray **100**. In some embodiments, one of a plurality of pull tabs **420** are coupled to each of the covers **400**. In other embodiments, the pull tab **420** is coupled to the covers **400**.

III. Overview of Method of Packaging *Cannabis*

[0052] FIG. **12** depicts an example of a method **500** for packaging *cannabis* (e.g., a method for compressing *cannabis*, a method for inhaling *cannabis* smoke, etc.). The method **500** is configured to receive a *cannabis* mixture **200**, press the *cannabis* mixture **200** into the *cannabis* puck **102** inside of a package, and cover the *cannabis* puck **102** in the package. In this way, the *cannabis* puck **102** may be supplied to and enable the use of the *cannabis* puck **102** by a user (e.g., smoking *cannabis*, etc.)

[0053] The method **500** begins with step **510** which includes mixing (e.g., combining, creating, etc.) the *cannabis* mixture **200**. The *cannabis* mixture **200** includes the portion of ground *cannabis* **210** and the binder **220**. The binder **220** includes at least one of a portion of *cannabis* resin **222** or a portion of hemp oil **224**. In some embodiments, the binder **220** includes both the portion of *cannabis* resin **222** and the portion of hemp oil **224**. The step **510** may include mixing a plurality of *cannabis* mixtures **200**. In some embodiments, the *cannabis* mixture **200** includes additional ingredients (e.g., loose *cannabis*, preservation agents, etc.).

[0054] The method **500** continues with step **520** which includes placing (e.g., setting, filling, etc.) a first of the *cannabis* mixture **200** into a first of the capsule mold **120** of the tray **100**. In some embodiments, the method **500** also includes step **522** which includes placing a second of the *cannabis* mixture **200** into a second of the capsule mold **120** in parallel with step **520**. In some embodiments, the method **500** includes placing one of a plurality of *cannabis* mixtures **200** into each of the capsule molds **120**.

[0055] The method **500** continues with step **524** which includes placing (e.g., setting, etc.) the tray **100** onto a supporting mold **350** (e.g., a supporting frame, a stand, etc.). The supporting mold **350** is configured to substantially support and stabilize the tray **100**. In some embodiments, the supporting mold **350** may be in confronting relation with the capsule exterior **122** when the tray **100** is placed on the supporting mold **350**.

[0056] The method **500** continues with step **530** which includes pressing (e.g., compressing, compacting, etc.) the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200** into the first of the capsule mold **120** to form a first of the *cannabis* puck **102**. In step **530**, the compressive force **300** is applied to the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200** so that the binder **220** binds together the portion of ground *cannabis* **210** inside of the *cannabis* mixture **200**. In some embodiments, compressive force **300** travels through the *cannabis* puck **102**, through the capsule mold **120**, and into a surface. In other embodiments, the compressive force **300** travels through the *cannabis* puck **102**, through the capsule mold **120**, through the supporting mold **350**, and then into the surface.

[0057] In some embodiments, the method **500** may also include step **532** which includes applying heat from a heater **332** to the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200** to form the first *cannabis* puck **102**. In step **532**, heat from the heater **332** is applied to the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200** so that the *cannabis* trichomes in the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200** separate from the ground *cannabis* **210** after the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200** is heated and cause the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200** to bind itself together. Heat may be applied by the controller causing power to be supplied from the power source to the heater **332**. In some embodiments, step **532** includes applying heat from a first of the heater **332** of the press **310** to the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200**. For example, the first of the heater **332** may be configured to increase the temperature of a first of the press cylinder **330**

such that the temperature of the first of the press cylinder **330** is higher than the temperature of the *cannabis* mixture **200**. The first of the press cylinder **330** then transfers heat to the *cannabis* mixture **200** such that temperature of the *cannabis* mixture **200** is increased and the *cannabis* trichomes separate from the ground *cannabis* **210**. In other embodiments, heat is applied through an alternate means (e.g., increasing a temperature of an environment surrounding the *cannabis* mixture, preheating the *cannabis* mixture **200**, etc.). In some embodiments, step **532** and step **530** may be performed simultaneously. In other embodiments, step **530** and step **532** are not performed simultaneously (e.g., heat is applied to the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200** before pressing the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200**, heat is applied to the first of the *cannabis* mixture **200** after pressing the first *cannabis* mixture **200**, etc.).

[0058] In some embodiments, the method **500** also includes step **534** which includes pressing the second of the *cannabis* mixture **200** into the second of the capsule mold **120** to form a second of the *cannabis* puck **102**. In some embodiments, step **530** and step **534** are performed simultaneously. In other embodiments, step **530** and step **534** are not performed simultaneously.

[0059] In some embodiments, the method **500** also includes step **536** which includes applying heat from a heater to the second of the *cannabis* mixture **200**. In step **536**, heat from a heater is applied to the second of the *cannabis* mixture **200** so that the *cannabis* trichomes in the second of the *cannabis* mixture **200** separate from the ground *cannabis* **210** after the second of the *cannabis* mixture **200** is heated and cause the second of the *cannabis* mixture **200** to bind itself together. In some embodiments, step **536** includes applying heat from a second of the heater **332** of the press **310** to the second of the *cannabis* mixture **200**. In other embodiments, step **536** includes applying heat from the first of the heater **332** of the press **310** to the second of the *cannabis* mixture **200**. In some embodiments, step **534** and step **536** may be performed simultaneously. In other embodiments, step **534** and step **536** are nor performed simultaneously.

[0060] The method **500** continues with step **540** which includes covering (e.g., enclosing, capping, etc.) the first of the *cannabis* puck **102** inside of the first of the capsule mold **120** with a first of the cover **400**. In some embodiments, the method **500** also includes step **542** which includes covering the second of the *cannabis* puck **102** inside of the second of the capsule mold **120** with a second of the cover **400**. In other embodiments, the method **500** continues with step **544** which includes covering the first of the *cannabis* puck **102** inside of the first of the capsule mold **120** and covering the second of the *cannabis* puck **102** inside of the second of the capsule mold **120** with a first of the cover **400**. In some embodiments, step **540** may be performed in an inert environment (e.g., such that the *cannabis* puck **102** is not exposed to moisture or other contaminants, etc.). In some embodiments, step **540** may be performed in a vacuum (e.g., such that the *cannabis* puck **102** does not oxidize, etc.).

[0061] In some embodiments, the method **500** concludes with step **546** which includes adhering (e.g., affixing, gluing, etc.) a first of the cover **400** to the tray **100** using the adhesive **410**. In some embodiments, the method **500** also includes step **548** which includes adhering the second of the cover **400** to the tray **100** using the adhesive **410**.

[0062] After the conclusion of the method **500**, a user may grasp (e.g., grab, grip, etc.) a portion of the pull tab **420** (e.g., a string, a strip, etc.) extending from the outside of the cover **400**, in some embodiments. The pull tab **420** may be configured to be easier to grab (e.g., has a higher surface friction, can be wrapped around a hand, etc.) than the cover **400**.

[0063] After the conclusion of the method **500**, a user may remove the first of the cover **400** from the tray **100**. In some embodiments, the user removes the first of the cover **400** to uncover the first of the *cannabis* puck **102**. In some embodiments, the user removes the first of the cover **400** to uncover the first of the *cannabis* puck **102** and the second of the *cannabis* puck **102**. In some embodiments, the first of the cover **400** may be re-adhered (e.g., replaced, resealed, etc.) to the tray top **112** using the adhesive **410** after being removed. In other embodiments, the adhesive **410** may no longer be used as an adhesive (e.g., lose its stickiness, etc.) after being removed from the tray **100**.

[0064] After the user removes the first of the cover **400** from the tray **100**, the user may remove the first of the *cannabis* puck **102** from the first of the capsule mold **120**. In some embodiments, a user may lift the first of the *cannabis* puck from the first of the capsule mold **120** using a hand of the user. In other embodiments, the user may tip (e.g., angle, rotate, etc.) the tray **100** such that first of the *cannabis* puck **102** falls from the first of the capsule mold **120**. In some embodiments, the user may place the first of the *cannabis* puck **102** into a device configured for smoking *cannabis* such that the puck bottom **342** of the first of the *cannabis* puck **102** contacts a bowl of the device. In some embodiments, the device may be a pipe or a bong.

[0065] After the user removes the first of the *cannabis* puck **102** from the first of the capsule mold **120**, the user may combust (e.g., light, setting on fire, etc.) the puck top **340**. The puck top **340** is combusted to transfer the active ingredients of the *cannabis* puck **102** into a smoke (e.g., vapor, gas, etc.) which carries the active ingredients through the air. In some embodiments, the combustion of the puck top **340** may expose additional parts of the *cannabis* puck **102** and allow for the additional parts of the *cannabis* puck **102** to be combusted as well. As a result, all of the *cannabis* puck **102** may be combusted in sequence from the puck top **340** to the puck bottom **342**. In some embodiments, the puck top **340** may be combusted with a butane lighter or a match.

[0066] After the user combusts the puck top **340**, the user may inhale smoke from the combustion of the puck top **340** through the puck bottom **342** of the *cannabis* puck **102**. In some embodiments, the *cannabis* puck **102** is located in a bowl of a pipe such that the smoke from the combustion of the puck top **340** travels through the puck bottom **342**, through a hole in the bottom of the bowl, and into the pipe where it may be inhaled by a user. In other embodiments, the user may inhale the smoke from the combustion of the puck top **340** through the puck bottom **342** in a different manner (e.g., after traveling through a bong, by allowing the smoke to spread into the atmosphere, etc.).

IV. Configuration of Example Embodiments

[0067] As utilized herein, the terms “approximately,” “about,” “substantially,” and similar terms are intended to have a broad meaning in harmony with the common and accepted usage by those of ordinary skill in the art to which the subject matter of this disclosure pertains. It should be understood by those of skill in the art who review this disclosure that these terms are intended to allow a description of certain features described and claimed without restricting the scope of these features to the precise numerical ranges provided. Accordingly, these terms should be interpreted as indicating that insubstantial or inconsequential modifications or alterations of the subject matter described and claimed are considered to be within the scope of the disclosure as recited in the appended claims.

[0068] It should be noted that the term "exemplary" and variations thereof, as used herein to describe various embodiments, are intended to indicate that such embodiments are possible examples, representations, or illustrations of possible embodiments (and such terms are not intended to connote that such embodiments are necessarily extraordinary or superlative examples).

[0069] The term "coupled" and variations thereof, as used herein, means the joining of two members directly or indirectly to one another. Such joining may be stationary (e.g., permanent or fixed) or moveable (e.g., removable or releasable). Such joining may be achieved with the two members coupled directly to each other, with the two members coupled to each other using a separate intervening member and any additional intermediate members coupled with one another, or with the two members coupled to each other using an intervening member that is integrally formed as a single unitary body with one of the two members. If "coupled" or variations thereof are modified by an additional term (e.g., directly coupled), the generic definition of "coupled" provided above is modified by the plain language meaning of the additional term (e.g., "directly coupled" means the joining of two members without any separate intervening member), resulting in a narrower definition than the generic definition of "coupled" provided above. Such coupling may be mechanical, electrical, or fluidic.

[0070] References herein to the positions of elements (e.g., "top," "bottom," "above," "below") are merely used to describe the orientation of various elements in the figures. It should be noted that the orientation of various elements may differ according to other exemplary embodiments, and that such variations are intended to be encompassed by the present disclosure.

[0071] Although the figures and description may illustrate a specific order of method steps, the order of such steps may differ from what is depicted and described, unless specified differently above. Also, two or more steps may be performed concurrently or with partial concurrence, unless specified differently above. Such variation may depend, for example, on the software and hardware systems chosen and on designer choice. All such variations are within the scope of the disclosure. Likewise, software implementations of the described methods could be accomplished with standard programming techniques with rule-based logic and other logic to accomplish the various connection steps, processing steps, comparison steps, and decision steps.

[0072] It is important to note that the construction and arrangement of the *cannabis* pack **10** and components thereof as shown in the various exemplary embodiments is illustrative only. Additionally, any element disclosed in one embodiment may be incorporated or utilized with any other embodiment disclosed herein.

What is claimed is:

1. A method for packaging *cannabis*, the method comprising:

placing a first portion of ground *cannabis* into a first capsule mold of a tray;

pressing the first portion of ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold to form a first *cannabis* puck;

attaching a first cover to the tray to cover the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold; and

attaching a first pull tab to the first cover, the first pull tab configured to be grasped by a user when the user removes the first cover from covering the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold.

2. The method of claim **1**, further comprising:

placing a second *cannabis* mixture into a second capsule mold of the tray;

pressing the second *cannabis* mixture into the second capsule mold of the tray to form a second *cannabis* puck;

wherein:

the step of attaching the first cover to the tray to cover the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold further comprises attaching the first cover to the tray to cover the second *cannabis* puck in the second capsule mold; and

the first pull tab is configured to be grasped by the user when the user removes the first cover from covering the second *cannabis* puck in the second capsule mold.

3. The method of claim **1**, wherein the step of attaching the first pull tab to the first cover further comprising orienting the first pull tab such that the first pull tab extends from the first cover.

4. The method of claim **1**, wherein the step of attaching the first pull tab to the first cover occurs before the step of attaching the first cover to the tray.

5. The method of claim **1**, further comprising:

placing a second *cannabis* mixture into a second capsule mold of the tray;

pressing the second *cannabis* mixture into the second capsule mold of the tray to form a second *cannabis* puck;

attaching a second cover to the tray to cover the second *cannabis* puck in the second capsule mold; and

attaching a second pull tab to the second cover, the second pull tab configured to be grasped by the user when the user removes the second cover from covering the second *cannabis* puck in the second capsule mold.

6. The method of claim **1**, wherein after the method concludes the user grasps the first pull tab to remove the first cover from covering the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold and removes the first *cannabis* puck from the first capsule mold.

7. The method of claim **1**, further comprising:

applying heat to the first portion of ground *cannabis* after placing the first portion of ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold of the tray, wherein the step of pressing the first portion of ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold occurs simultaneously with the step of applying heat to the first portion of ground *cannabis*.

8. A method for packaging *cannabis*, the method comprising:

placing a first portion of ground *cannabis* into a first capsule mold of a tray;

placing a second portion of ground *cannabis* into a second capsule mold of the tray;

pressing the first portion of ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold to form a first *cannabis* puck;

pressing the second portion of ground *cannabis* into the second capsule mold to form a second *cannabis* puck;
attaching a first cover to the tray to cover the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold; and
attaching a second cover to the tray to cover the second *cannabis* puck in the second capsule mold.

9. The method of claim **8**, further comprising:
attaching a first pull tab to the first cover, the first pull tab configured to be grasped by a user when the user removes the first cover from covering the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold.

10. The method of claim **9**, further comprising:
attaching a second pull tab to the second cover, the second pull tab configured to be grasped by the user when the user removes the second cover from covering the second *cannabis* puck in the second capsule mold.

11. The method of claim **8**, wherein the step of attaching the first cover to the tray to cover the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold further comprises adhering the first cover to the tray to cover the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold and the step of attaching the second cover to the tray to cover the second *cannabis* puck in the second capsule mold further comprises adhering the second cover to the tray to cover the second *cannabis* puck.

12. The method of claim **8**, further comprising:
applying heat to the first portion of ground *cannabis* after placing the first portion of ground *cannabis* mixture into the first capsule mold of the tray.

13. The method of claim **12**, wherein the step of pressing the first portion of ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold occurs simultaneously with the step of applying heat to the first portion of ground *cannabis*.

14. The method of claim **8**, wherein the step of pressing the first portion of ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold occurs simultaneously with the step of pressing the second portion of ground *cannabis* into the second capsule mold.

15. A method for packaging *cannabis*, the method comprising:
placing a first portion of a ground *cannabis* into a first capsule mold of a tray;
pressing the first portion of the ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold of the tray to form a first *cannabis* puck;
applying heat to the first portion of the ground *cannabis* after placing the first portion of the ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold of the tray, wherein the step of pressing the first portion of the ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold occurs simultaneously with the step of applying heat to the first portion of the ground *cannabis*; and
attaching a first cover to the tray to cover the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold.

16. The method of claim **15**, wherein after the method concludes a user removes the first cover from covering the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold and removes the first *cannabis* puck from the first capsule mold.

17. The method of claim **16**, wherein the user grasps a pull tab coupled to the first cover when the user removes the first cover from covering the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold.

18. The method of claim **15**, further comprising:
placing the tray onto a supporting mold prior to pressing the first portion of ground *cannabis* into the first capsule mold to form the first *cannabis* puck.

19. The method of claim **15**, further comprising:
placing a second portion of ground *cannabis* into a second capsule mold of the tray; and
pressing the second portion of ground *cannabis* into the second capsule mold of the tray to form a second *cannabis* puck;
wherein the step of attaching the first cover to the tray to cover the first *cannabis* puck in the first capsule mold further comprises attaching the first cover to the tray to cover the second *cannabis* puck in the second capsule mold.

20. The method of claim **15**, further comprising:
placing a second portion of ground *cannabis* into a second capsule mold of the tray;
pressing the second portion of ground *cannabis* into the second capsule mold of the tray to form a second *cannabis* puck; and
attaching a second cover to the tray to cover the second *cannabis* puck in the second capsule mold.

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